UP: RUMBLINGS IN THE YOGI REGIME
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UPFRONT

BRINGING BACK THE CHEETAH
PG 8



SCREEN TIME A passenger is checked for monkeypox symptoms after arrival at the Chennai international airport

ANI

HEALTH

MONKEY ON THE BACK

By Sonali Acharjee

Taking note of the over 16,000 monkeypox cases in 75 countries, the World Health Organization (WHO) on July 23 declared the disease a public health emergency of international concern. First discovered in 1958, the virus was mostly confined to central and western Africa until the past few months when it spread rapidly around the world. Four cases have been reported in India so far. "Previous cases happened when people travelled to the endemic zone. The virus was of less concern when it was confined there, but now it is circulating in large numbers around the world," says virologist Dr Gagandeep Kang.

Some symptoms of monkeypox are similar to those of smallpox, though clinically less severe. During past outbreaks in Africa, the disease was reported to begin with flu-like symptoms, such as fever, fatigue and a swollen lymph node, followed about a week later with painful blisters first on the face and then the hands and feet. The blisters, ranging from 10 to 200 bumps, can get aggravated and filled with pus. As the infection runs its course, the blisters scab over and fall off. "If you scratch the blisters, they could leave scars, just like chickenpox," says Mumbai-based infectious disease expert Dr Anita